

Hisense India's next chapter

In conversation with CEO Pankaj Rana

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The television market rarely stands still, but few companies have ridden the momentum of large screen adoption as aggressively as Hisense. Globally, the brand has surged to the top of the premium display segment. According to Omdia's Q1 2025 data, Hisense holds a dominant 56.7% global volume share in 100-inch and above TVs, leading for three consecutive years. It is also number one in MiniLED and Laser TV shipments, reflecting a long-term focus on large screen innovation, advanced backlight technology, and an ecosystem built around immersive viewing. Yet in India, the story is still being written.

To understand that story, I sat down with Pankaj Rana, the CEO of Hisense India, who has spent the last year expanding the brand's footprint from digital marketplaces into brick-and-mortar retail, while simultaneously preparing the company for a broader push into home appliances.

Rana begins on a personal note, talking about evenings spent watching cricket and European football, interests shaped partly by Hisense's role as a global football sponsor.

As he puts it, "I'm an avid sports enthusiast. Cricket has always been

there, but ever since Hisense became a global sponsor for soccer, I've developed a keen interest in following clubs and matches more closely."

The conversation moves to how Indian viewing behaviour has evolved.

According to Rana, the biggest shift in the last decade has been awareness.

Consumers today walk into showrooms asking about MiniLED, refresh rates, gaming support, and HDR formats. Such conversations were unheard of when he began handling TVs at Panasonic in 2010. This change, he says, has been shaped in large part by the smartphone era, which has conditioned us to compare specifications before deciding.

That shift in behaviour has coincided with a structural one. The reduction of GST on TVs above 32-inches has made larger screens significantly more affordable. Add no-cost EMI schemes and longer tenures, and buyers are comfortably upgrading from 55-inch sets to 75-inch or even 85-inch models. Rana points out this trend accelerated in the pandemic.

"People realised during COVID how special it is to watch content together as a family. Even if someone doesn't have a very large wall, they still aspire to buy a 75 or 85-inch TV."



Pankaj Rana
CEO, Hisense India

Since GST reforms, Hisense has seen strong festive sales and more than 65% growth in the last 60 days across online and offline channels.

A key part of Hisense's global edge is its display innovation, especially RGB Mini LED technology. Rana explains that the benefit is immediately visible to the viewer. Blacks appear deeper, the contrast ratio is higher, and the overall image has a cinematic softness that reduces eye strain over long hours. Hisense expects it to meaningfully trickle down to mainstream sizes between 2026 and 2028 as adoption grows and panel costs stabilise.

Audio is another strong pillar, and Hisense's partnership with Devialet is aimed at elevating sound quality, which Rana believes is central to the Indian viewing experience. High bass, better channel separation, and cinematic tuning are priorities because, as he puts it, a picture alone cannot create immersion.

Under Rana's leadership, Hisense has made a deliberate shift toward mainline retail through partnerships with Great Eastern and Sathya Agencies. He stresses that offline retail will be the brand's most critical growth lever in 2025 and 2026. "For large screen TVs, offline demonstration is irreplaceable. People need to see the difference between MiniLED, QLED and 4K with their own eyes."

Service will be equally crucial. Hisense is pushing for 24-hour installation in most cities, 48-hour service in smaller towns, and faster turnaround on repairs. A central CRM led system aims to provide real-time updates to customers, something Rana calls key to customer delight.

Looking beyond TVs, Hisense is preparing for a full-scale appliance push. Mass production of air conditioners at the Sri City plant begins this winter, and more white goods will follow. The long-term goal is to position Hisense not as a TV maker but as a multi-product brand capable of building a full home ecosystem. **d**